

Latex Resume System

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Contents

1	What this system is	2
2	What you need	2
3	Install and check	2
4	Repo layout	2
5	How to work with the AI	3
6	First run: update the master	4
7	Second run: tailor for one job	4
8	Rules that keep the PDF correct	4
9	Skills reference	5
10	Lorem Ipsum template note	5
11	Fixes for common fails	5
12	Daily checklist	6

1 What this system is

This repo holds a LaTeX resume template plus a set of skills an AI can follow. You open the repo in a code editor. You keep a command line AI or a panel AI on the side. You tell the AI what to change. It edits the `.tex` file directly and compiles it to PDF.

The template uses Lorem Ipsum plus X metrics as placeholders. You replace them with your real school, work, and projects. The format stays the same.

The skills folder gives the AI the rules it needs. That is why small models work here. They do not need to guess. The scope is fixed and the checks are fixed.

2 What you need

You need three things: an editor, LaTeX, and one extension.

- An editor. Use VS Code, Cursor, or Antigravity. Any of the three works.
- AI access. Use a command line tool in the terminal or the built in AI panel. Both work the same way for this system.
- LaTeX. Download it here: <https://www.latex-project.org/get/>. On Mac this is MacTeX. On Windows use MiKTeX or TeX Live. On Linux use TeX Live from your package manager.
- One extension. Install LaTeX Workshop by James Yu. It is a VS Code extension. It also installs in Cursor and Antigravity. It gives syntax highlight and preview. The command line compile below still applies.

Use a small to medium model. Large models add little here. The task is narrow: edit text, keep one page, compile. Small models do this well when they have the skill files.

3 Install and check

Do the steps in order. Stop if a step fails.

1. Install LaTeX from <https://www.latex-project.org/get/>.
2. Install the editor of your choice.
3. In the editor, install LaTeX Workshop by James Yu.
4. Open the repo folder in the editor. Confirm you see `Resume/User/main.tex` and `Resume/Skills/`.
5. Open a terminal in the repo and run:

```
pdflatex -interaction=nonstopmode main.tex
```

Run it inside the folder that holds the file you want to check.
6. Confirm the exit code is 0 and a one page PDF appears. Delete the helper files after the check:

```
rm main.aux main.log main.out
```

If `pdflatex` is not found, LaTeX did not install correctly or its path is missing. Reinstall from the link above and restart the terminal.

4 Repo layout

<code>Resume/User/main.tex</code>	master resume, LaTeX template
<code>Resume/Skills/</code>	rules the AI follows

Resume/Walkthrough/ this guide plus post and readme drafts
Resume/[Company]/main.tex one folder per tailored resume

Resume/User/main.tex is the master. Keep it as your source of truth. Never overwrite it when you tailor for a job. Copy it into a new company folder instead.

Resume/Skills/ holds ten short rule files. The main ones are Tailor, Preparation, Coverletter, Breakdown, Linkedin, Humaizer, Projects, Research, and Promotion. The AI reads the one it needs before it edits.

5 How to work with the AI

Keep the resume file open on one side and the AI on the other. Point the AI at the exact files. Paste the job post when you tailor.

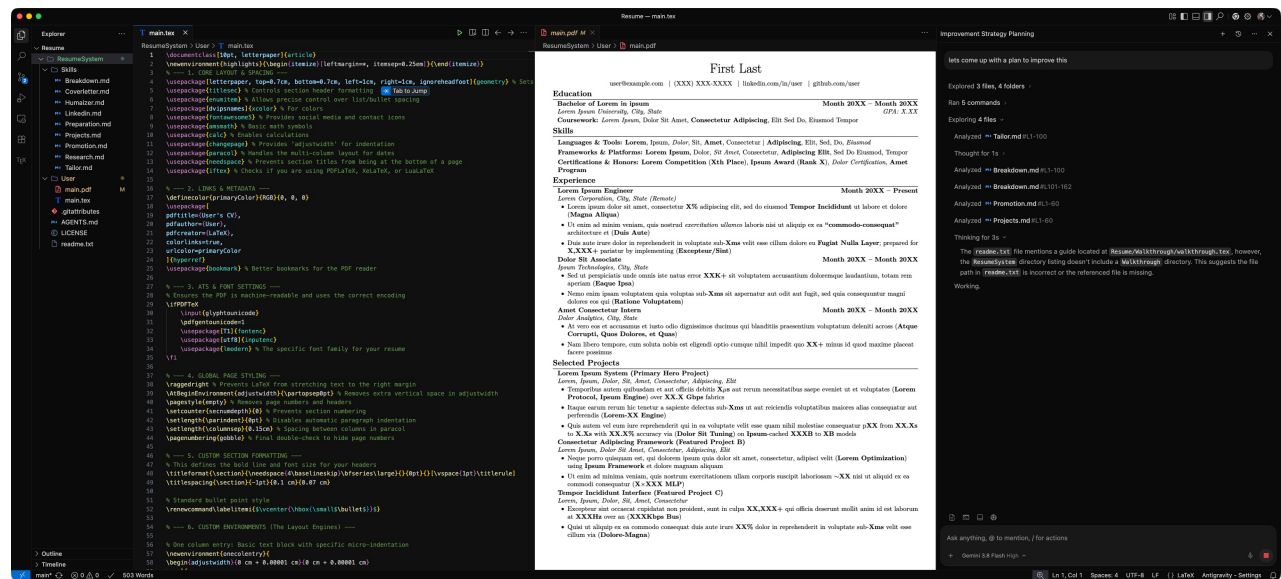


Figure 1: Editor with main.tex source, PDF preview, and AI panel side by side.

A good first prompt looks like this:

Read Resume/User/main.tex and Resume/Skills/Tailor.md.

Here is the job post: [paste].

List the match score and gaps. Wait for my approval.

Rules for prompts:

- Name the files. Do not say “my resume”. Say Resume/User/main.tex.
- Name the skill. Say which file in Resume/Skills/ applies.
- Paste facts. Dates, school, titles, metrics. The AI must not invent them.
- Ask it to wait. Review the plan before it edits.

Model choice: pick the small or medium option your tool offers. From repeated use, that size handles these edits without extra cost or delay. If output gets vague, the fix is usually a clearer prompt, not a larger model.

6 First run: update the master

Use this when your facts change: new term, new internship, new project, new skills.

1. Open `Resume/User/main.tex`.
2. Tell the AI what changed and give the facts.
3. Tell it to keep native LaTeX only. No markdown in the `.tex` file.
4. Tell it to compile with `pdflatex -interaction=nonstopmode main.tex`.
5. Check the result: exit code 0, one page only, no date split across two lines, no overfull box warnings.
6. Delete `main.aux`, `main.log`, and `main.out`.

Date format: keep each range on one line. The template uses an unbreakable box with non breaking spaces, for example `\mbox{\textbf{Month~20XX~---Present}}`. Do not let a month and year split across lines.

7 Second run: tailor for one job

Tailoring means a small set of edits for one posting. It does not mean rewriting your history.

The order is fixed:

1. Research. The AI reads the posting and, when needed, the company stack and engineering posts. It notes the tools and the style they value.
2. Gap list. It compares the posting to your master and lists gaps in plain bullets. It gives a match score from 0 to 100.
3. Approval. You approve or reject each change. If a skill is missing, it asks you directly. It adds nothing you do not confirm.
4. Implement. It copies `Resume/User/main.tex` to `Resume/[Company]/main.tex` and edits the copy. Then it compiles and checks one page.

Tech swaps stay truthful. If a posting lists Azure and you used AWS for the same type of work, the AI can swap the label where the architecture matches. It must not add tools you never used. It must not invent users, scale, or revenue.

Skills section is flexible. Remove tools the role does not need. Move the relevant ones up. Keep keywords from the posting only where they match real work.

8 Rules that keep the PDF correct

These rules apply to every resume edit.

- One page only. If text spills to page two, cut back. The ceiling is 14 bullets across experience plus projects. Fifteen bullets with normal length will overflow.
- Fill empty space with facts. If the page looks short after compile, split a dense bullet into two, or add detail to secondary roles, architecture, tests, or performance numbers you can defend. Do not add fluff.
- Keep dates on one line. See the prior section for the format.

- Keep native LaTeX. Use `\textbf{}`, `\textit{}`, and `\href{}{}`. Never put markdown bold, italic, or links in a `.tex` file.
- Keep the layout. Do not change margins, fonts, or spacing commands to force fit.
- Keep versions safe. Master stays in `Resume/User/`. Each tailored resume gets its own `Resume/[Company]/` folder.
- Compile every time. Exit code 0, one page, dates on one line, no overfull warnings. Then remove the helper files.

9 Skills reference

Read only the skill you need for the task at hand.

- Tailor. Role research, gap list, approval, edits, compile gate. Start here for job posts.
- Promotion. Format for two roles at the same company. Keeps one tenure line with clear role steps.
- Preparation. Company profile, hero project pick, short pitch, likely deep dive questions.
- Coverletter. Short letter tied to the posting and your real work.
- Breakdown. Term by term check of your resume so you can defend each claim in review.
- Linkedin. Turns resume lines into plain LinkedIn text in `Resume/User/Linkedin.txt`.
- Humaizer. Cuts AI tone from prose. Short sentences. Plain words. No filler.
- Projects. Spare project patterns when you need a third project to fill the page.
- Research. How to read a company stack from docs and engineering posts with care.

10 Lorem Ipsum template note

The master ships with Lorem Ipsum text and X metrics such as X percent or X ms. These are placeholders. They show the style: bold metric, plain context, tool in parentheses at the end.

Replace every placeholder with a fact you can defend. Keep the shape: what you built, the result in numbers, the tools in parentheses. If you lack a number, state the scope in plain terms instead of inventing one.

11 Fixes for common fails

- Command not found for `pdflatex`. LaTeX path is missing. Reinstall from the link in section 3 and restart the terminal.
- PDF has two pages. Cut to 14 bullets or fewer. Shorten the longest bullets first. Recompile.
- Date wraps to two lines. Put the range in the unbreakable box form from section 6. Keep the date column as set in the template.
- Overfull box warning. A line is too long. Shorten the words or split the bullet. Do not shrink margins.
- Extension shows errors but terminal compile passes. Trust the terminal exit code. Reload the editor window.
- AI adds skills you do not have. Reject the swap. Give the AI the exact list of tools you used.

12 Daily checklist

1. Pull up the master or the company copy you plan to change.
2. Read the matching skill file first.
3. Give facts, approve the plan, then allow edits.
4. Compile, check one page and dates, remove helper files.
5. Save the PDF with the company name before you send it.